

LOCAL

Indians eliminated in final seconds

By SCOTT SOMMERS
Morning Journal Correspondent

STRONGSVILLE — Oberlin battled, but its bid to advance another step was thwarted in the waning moments.

In the Division IV district semifinal, Mapleton scored five straight points in the final 14 seconds to erase a two-point Oberlin lead and end its season with a 62-59 victory.

Down by as many as seven in the fourth quarter, the Indians (12-10) took a 58-57 lead after a pair of Brandon Bowen free throws with 1:04 left. Indians sophomore guard Morgan Jones, who scored a team-high 17 points, pushed their lead to two after a free throw with 27 seconds left.

Following a time-out by the Mounties (5-18), a play they practiced came to light when Nick Reuer drilled a 3-pointer with 14 seconds left to give them a 60-59 lead.

"We wanted to go for the win," Mapleton coach Joe Combs said. "We executed great down the stretch, especially on that play. The screens we set gave Nick probably our most-often look of the night."

Undaunted, the Indians pushed the ball up the court. It led to a Mounties foul

with 7.5 seconds left.

In the double bonus, the Indians failed to convert on both free throws. They were 9-of-15 from the line, and the Mounties rebounded the ball, which led to a quick foul. Reuer drilled both of them, putting both crowds to their feet.

Pushing the ball up the court again, the Indians' game-tying 3 came up short to send the Mounties to the district final.

"We missed some free throws and that hurt us a bit," Indians coach Kurt Russell said. "We played our run-and-jump defense and we gave up some big shots. We didn't shoot the ball real well, plus at times we were a little tentative against their defense."

It was a matter of patience on offense

and a hustling zone defense by the Mounties that gave the Indians fits.

Against the Mounties' zone, the Indians were unable to establish any sort of inside presence. Relegated to shooting from the outside, the Indians struggled. They were just 22-of-67 from the floor for 33 percent. It was their unrelenting pressure defense, which forced 31 turnovers, that kept them close throughout the game.

Down 50-42 with just under four minutes to play, the Indians went on a 9-3 run to close the deficit to 53-52. Kris Robinson, who scored 11 points, had five during the run. He also had his third 3-pointer of the game. Josh Daniels, who scored 11, added a pair of free throws and

Jones added a free throw.

Bowen, who sat with foul trouble for most of the game, gave the Indians a 56-55 lead with his layup with 1:21 left. The Mounties quickly reclaimed the lead with a pair of free throws, before Bowen put them up for the final time with a pair of his own.

Even though the season ended, Russell was proud of the effort his team gave, while looking toward next season. The Indians' 12 victories are an eight-win improvement from last year's 4-18 finish.

"The kids played very hard," he said. "Even though the loss hurts, we are going to keep our heads up. We know that we have to work on things and we will do so."

CLIPPERS

From Page C1

Then, a little over a month ago, the Clippers nearly ended Lutheran West's regular season winning streak that was finally halted at 61 a few games later.

Last night, they came back from double-digit deficits twice before finally falling.

"Good teams will spurt you back maybe once or twice," Lutheran West coach Phil Argento said. "I think we have a pretty good team and we're not going to panic."

First, the Longhorns built a 15-point lead late in the first half. Clearview cut it to four in the third quarter.

Then, the Longhorns went back up by 12 midway through the third. Clearview cut that to one early in the fourth.

"It would have been easy to say 'Here we go again,' Lutheran West is going to beat us again," Szalay said.

The Clippers instead opened the fourth with a 3 by Matt Chonko. Mike Rosey then followed with another 3 for six points within the first 30 seconds, and the score was 46-45.

Clearview hung around for a while. The Clippers did so by beating the bigger Longhorns in transition and forcing turnovers. It was still working when Troy Simmons scored off a steal and fell to the ground with 5:16 left. He was fouled on the play, but missed the free throw. At the time, Clearview was down, 54-49, while beating Lutheran West on the perimeter.

That was when the Longhorns finally got the ball back inside.

They went on a 9-2 run to put the game out of reach, and Mike Telzrow reasserted his post presence. He scored

twice inside, first to make it a 10-point game and then to make it 63-51 with 1:54 left.

Telzrow finished with 11 points and eight rebounds, but Andrew Hofener had a game-high 18 points and 12 rebounds. They weren't alone, either. Backup Jake Sermak added 10 points and six rebounds for the triple-headed force.

"We complement each other a lot," said Hofener, the tallest of the group, which ranges from 6-foot-4 to 6-6. "Our high-low game is always there. Me and Mike get assists to each other, and I love playing with them."

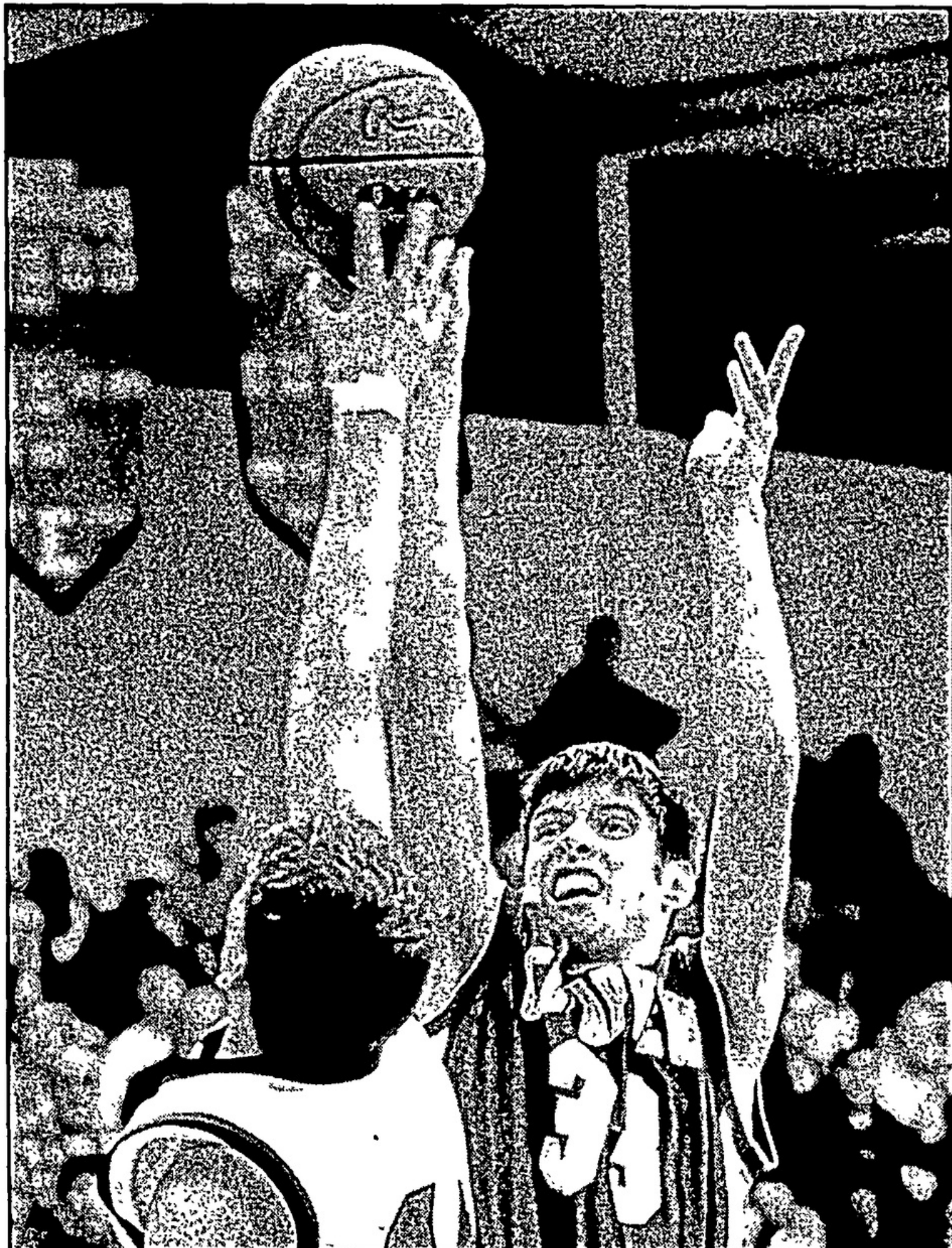
The trio made up for many deficiencies in the Longhorns' game last night. They committed 23 turnovers, but beat Clearview on the boards by 13. Scott Voiers, who scores about 19 points per game, was held scoreless, but the three-some inside combined for 39 points and 26 rebounds.

"I wish I had one of those guys ready for next year, but they're all in the same class. What do you do?" Argento said.

He, at least, will coach his seniors for another game. They will face Chancel, a 72-56 winner over CVCA, for the district title.

Szalay, though, still had no regrets, even though most of his team will graduate in June.

"Sometimes that can blow up in your face," he said. "I've never done it before. Coach (Bob) Walsh taught me differently. But this was a rare group. They accepted their roles, they were good friends, and so I rolled the dice. I'm happy with 70-percent winning percentage and getting a shot at a very good team in the districts. That's all I could ask."



Clearview's Dash Sokol, right, shoots while defended by Lutheran West's Andrew Hofener last night.

FALLS

From Page C1

However, it was all Falls after that.

Senior Tyler Sparks scored six of his game-high 23 points to close out the first half and put his Bulldogs back on top to stay, 33-27.

"It's always tough to lose," Herchler said. "Falls is a good basketball team, and it's sad to see our season end."

The Sailors only trailed 42-36 late in the third quarter. But a basket by Sparks with just over 3:32 remaining in the period ignited the Bulldogs.

It was followed by two steals, resulting in 3-pointers by Jim Brabene and Pat Pellerite.

"They're a great basketball team and we knew that coming in," said senior guard J.P. Krill. "But we watched some film of them and thought if we played physical with them, we'd have a chance to win."

Voreis finished with a team-high 18 points and Herchler added 13.

"We played really well in the first half and hung with them," Habermehl said. "But they had a big run there in the third quarter and we couldn't recover from that."

Community Scoreboard

BOYS VARSITY HOOPS

Olmsted Falls 71, Vermilion 46
Division III Westlake District Semifinal
VERMILION — Andy Pava 3-0, Kurtis Henscher 3-4 13, J.R. Hoot 1-1, Cory Truitt 2-0 24, Matt Lipgren 1-0 2, Colin Veres 6-2 18. TOTALS 181-46.

OLMSTED FALLS — Mike Sallard 3-17, Kyle Burdick 4-9, Drew Nelson 3-3, Tyler Sparks 4-12, Jim Robinson 3-0 8, Pat Nelson 4-6 16. TOTALS 213-71.

3-POINT GOALS — W: Henscher, OF: Burdick, Sparks, Robinson 5, P: Nelson 2.

Score by Quarters
Vermilion 15-7 15 17 14 4 — 46
Olmsted Falls 20-26 12 24 24 2 — 62

Team Statistics
Field Goals — Vermilion 41 of 50 (82 percent), Olmsted Falls 21 of 51 (41 percent).

Free Throws — V: 7 of 12 (58 percent), OF: 23 of 31 (74 percent).

Rebounds — V: 34 (Nelson 12, OF: 24 (Sparks) 9), Turnovers — V: 22, OF: 12.

Lutheran West 65, Clearview 58
Division III Elyria District Semifinal
CLEARVIEW — Chris Newman 3-1, Mike Neeb 1-3, Dash Sokol 4-3, Troy Simmons 5-11, Mike Rosey 5-14, Steven Lindsey 0-0, Matt Chonko 2-7, David Chapman 1-0 2, Cory Argento 0-0, James Washington 1-0 2, Robert Green 0-0, Anthony Hanson 1-0 3, Jordan Celestino 0-0 0, TOTALS 234-58.

LUTHERAN WEST — Scott Valero 0-0, Andrew Hokenor 7-14 18, Mike Telzrow 4-3 11, Dave Mordell 1-6 8, Jacob Chaska 3-10, Andrew Thomas 3-0 8, Jake Sermak 5-10, Paul Fackler 0-0, Ben Henshell 0-0, Ryan Fisher 0-0 0, Col Thoney 0-0 0, TOTALS 241-65.

3-POINT GOALS — C: Rosey (3), Newman, Chonko, Hokenor, LW: Thomas (2).

Score by Quarters
Clearview 16-7 12 19 19 — 55
Lutheran West 20-11 14 18 14 — 65

Team Statistics
Field Goals — Clearview 26 of 47 (55 percent), Lutheran West 24 of 47 (51 percent).

Free Throws — C: 6 of 10 (60 percent), LW: 17 of 27 (63 percent).

Rebounds — C: 28 (Rosey 8), LW: 41 (Hokenor 12), Turnovers — C: 15, LW: 22.

Mapleton 62, Oberlin 59
Division IV Strongsville District Semifinal
OBERLIN — Marvin Clump 3-0 8, Morgan Jones 6-11, Brandon Bowen 2-3, Vito Sabone 0-1 1, John Daniels 4-3 11, Josh Manning 2-0 4, TOTALS 222-59.

MAPLETON — Andrew Viter 5-17, Nick Reuer 4-4 15, J.R. Keneer 6-16, Aaron Thomas 1-0 3, Billy Keneer 5-12, Josh Alderman 2-0 4, TOTALS 241-62.

3-POINT GOALS — C: Chapman (3), Robinson (3), Jones, M. Reuer, J.R. Keneer.

Score by Quarters
Oberlin 12-10 12 13 14 20 — 59
Mapleton 15-18 11 14 22 — 62

Team Statistics
Field Goals — Oberlin 22 of 47 (47 percent), Mapleton 24 of 47 (51 percent).

Free Throws — O: 9 of 15 (60 percent), M: 17 of 27 (63 percent).

Rebounds — O: 29 (Bowen 6), M: 41.

Turnovers — M: 21.

BOYS HOOPS POSTSEASON

Division I
Brecksville District
Wednesday, March 7
Pharos vs. St. Edward 7
Thursday, March 8
Midway District
Wednesday, March 7
Strongsville vs. North Olmsted 7
Thursday, March 8
Brunswick vs. Elyria 7
Saturday, March 10
District final 7

Bowling Green District
(at Willard)
Thursday, March 8
Mansfield vs. Sandusky 7

Division II
Westlake District
Tuesday, March 6
Olmsted Falls 71, Vermilion 46
Wednesday, March 7
Rocky River vs. Holy Name 7
Friday, March 9
Olmsted Falls vs. Rocky River Holy Name winner, 7
Winner to Toledo Regional

Johnson hired as Elyria volleyball coach, Oberlin hires Kuchta to coach baseball

Morning Journal Staff

Elyria named John Johnson its new head girls volleyball coach to replace legendary Carol Russo, who retired at the end of last season.

Johnson graduated from Elyria in 1995 and was Lorain County's Miss Volleyball in 1994 and an All-Ohio second teamer.

Johnson graduated from Edinboro University and was the Pennsylvania State Athletic Conference Player of the Year in 1998.

Johnson returns to Elyria after coaching two seasons at Wheeling Park High School in West Virginia, where she won 27 games in two years for a program that won only eight games the year before.

"She will also be joining the teaching staff as a Health and Physical Education teacher."

In other coaching news, Oberlin hired Phil Kuchta as its baseball coach. Kuchta graduated from Elyria and was an All-Ohio pitcher in 1992. He most recently was an assistant baseball, basketball and football coach at Elyria Catholic.

Kuchta is currently completing a degree in Physical Education at Cleveland State while working at Murray Ridge in Elyria. He also served in the United States Marine Corps for six years.

At Elyria High School

Ozville (19-4) vs. Liberty Center (18-9)
Ravenna (21-0) vs. Garcon Howard/Lakota (24-0)
At Kenton North High School
Wadsworth (21-2) vs. Columbus Alliance (25-1)
Berlin Hazard (24-1) vs. South Western (15-9)

FRESHMAN HOOPS
Clearview Wins PAC
Clearview's freshman basketball team finished off its best season in school history with a 16-1 record, including a Pair of Athletic Conference championship. The Clippers were coached by Nick Danavich and Frank Owens Jr. The team consists of: Eric Thompson, Anthony Hitchens, Paul Wells, Sodman Valentin, Brian Chonko, Tony Williams, Colin Owens, Zach Anderson, Colin Watson, Kyle Burghart and Kevin Johnson.

JR. HIGH HOOPS
Clearview 28, Oberlin 17
Grade 8, Girls
CLEARVIEW — Shannon Carver 3, Rosa Yaremko 8, Andriana Carter 2, Monica Pagan 2, Alex Wilson 2, Al Scott 2, Bailey Owens 2, Amber Feneel 1
Longfellow 31
General Johnnie Wilson 18
Grade 7, Girls
LONGFELLOW — Gabby Campbell 12, Jayme Stull 8, Beanna Foremy 7, Ashley Mander 2
GENERAL JOHNNIE WILSON — Druell 8, Boncar 4, Heather 5, Fields 1

CYO HOOPS
St. Peter's (Lorain) 49, Lakewood Catholic Academy 39
SL Basketball Tournament Championship
Grade 8, Boys
ST. PETER'S — Ryan Hance 16, Joseph Nelson 13, Joe Johnson 10, Mark Anderson 6, John Miller 12
LAKESIDE — Ryan Hance 16, Joseph Nelson 13, Joe Johnson 10, Mark Anderson 6, John Miller 12
LAKESIDE — Ryan Hance 16, Joseph Nelson 13, Joe Johnson 10, Mark Anderson 6, John Miller 12
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LCCC Doubles Tennis Tournament

The second annual Lorain County Community College Indoor doubles tennis classic will be held Friday at 8 a.m. in the LCCC Field House. This event is open to the public. The entry fee is \$20. To register, contact Jim Powers at 1-800-995-5222 or (440) 367-9252.

Lorain County Hoops League
The Boys and Girls Clubs of Lorain County will be hosting a basketball league for 12-to-14-year-olds. There is no cost to join the league, but players need to be member of the Club or willing to join the league. Sign-ups and play begins Saturday from 10 a.m. to 1 p.m. at the Teen Center at St. Stanislaus, 2702 Elyria Avenue in Lorain.

New London Baseball Camp
Eastern Michigan University will be hosting an instructional baseball camp at New London High School on Saturday from 9 a.m. to 4 p.m. The first session will be for players ages 12 and the second session will be for players ages 13-18. The cost of the session is \$45. Any questions, contact Daniel Chaffin at (419) 929-4205 or Roger Coyne at (734) 487-0315.

Night at the Races
There will be a Night at the Races steak by dinner to benefit the Amherst 14-and-under travel baseball team Saturday from 5 p.m. to midnight at the Amherst Eagles on Cleveland Avenue. Donations are \$15 or \$20 for take-out. Contact Dave at (440) 755-0996 or Jim at (440) 756-1100.

6th Grade Girls Hoops Tournament
Sandusky S. May will be hosting a sixth grade girls basketball tournament this weekend at the multi-purpose gym. There is a \$100 entry fee with a three-game guarantee. All school teams only. For info, contact Kurt Furtum at (419) 556-4491 or (419) 821-8200.

Girls Basketball Clinic
Clearview will be hosting basketball clinics on March 17 starting at 9 a.m. There are different times for different ages. The clinics are located at Elyria Catholic at (440) 367-9252 for times and details.

Girls Basketball Camp
St. Peter's will be hosting a girls basketball camp starting March 17 for all current first, second and third grade girls interested in playing CYO basketball. Girls will learn fundamentals, rules and sportsmanship. The cost is \$45 which includes a T-shirt and award. For more information, call Tim Ernst at (440) 282-8889 or Mark Whelan at (440) 282-1308.

Girls Basketball League
South Amherst Middle School is looking for 6th grade girls basketball teams to play in a league that will be played on Sunday from March 18-27. The entry fee is \$250 per team. Contact Dave Knepp at (440) 367-9252 or (440) 367-9252.

Oak Harbor Girls Hoops Tournament
Oak Harbor will host a basketball tournament for 5th and 6th grade girls on March 22-25. The first 12 teams in each age group to register and make payment will place into the tournament. The cost is \$110 per team with a three game guarantee. The entry deadline is March 12. For more information, contact Denny at (419) 898-3758 or (419) 556-3853.

Massillon Youth Hoops Shootout

The fourth annual Massillon Youth Basketball Shootout will be held on March 23-25. The tournament is co-sponsored by the YMCA of Western Stark County and the Boys & Girls Club of Massillon. All games will be played on new regulation wood courts at both facilities. The tournament is for boys and girls teams entering 4th, 5th or 6th grades. The cost for the tournament is \$150 per team, and teams are guaranteed three games. Deadline to register is Friday, March 16 or when divisions are filled. Only 18 teams per grade/age are permitted. Contact Brian Smith at (330) 537-1116 or ymcaofstark@yhc.com, or Marcus Marshall at (330) 833-4395 for more information. You can also visit the tournament Web site at www.mtsbshootout.com.

Avon Little League Reverse Raffle
The Avon Little League reverse raffle will be held on March 24 at the 16th Heritage Club in Avon Lake. Tickets are \$85 per couple, which includes two dinners and one chance of \$60 for a single dinner and one chance. The grand prize is \$1,500. Food, wash, beer and DJ are included with ticket purchase. Doors will open at 6 p.m. For more information, call Mary or Mike Skolopich at (440) 357-5003.

Girls Hoops Tournament
Dorsey High School will be hosting an elementary girls basketball tournament on March 30-31 for girls grades 5-6th. Please contact Tim Mackey at (419) 735-2700 or Joe Fitzer at (419) 735-6241.

Spring Basketball League
Elyria Catholic will host its second annual spring basketball league for boys and girls in 4th-6th grade March 31 through April 23. Team or individual enrollment. Fees include all league costs and team T-shirts. Call (440) 371-3361 for further information.

Olmsted Falls Basketball Tournament
Olmsted Falls High School will host a youth basketball tournament on April 27-28 for 4th-6th grade boys and girls. The entry fee is \$185 which includes a three-game guarantee and storage fees. The deadline is April 4. Any questions, contact Roberts Sasse at (440) 755-2774.

Spring Youth Basketball Tournament
North American Youth Sports will host their annual spring youth tournament in Canton at St. Thomas High School on April 12-15. Will feature girls and boys teams from fifth to 12th grade. Cost is \$55 and teams are guaranteed at least two games. Entry deadline is March 23. For questions, call Mike at (440) 362-5912 or contact tournament director Dave Nash at (330) 322-1332.

Vermilion Spring Classic
The Vermilion Spring Classic (Henderson) will be held April 19-22. The entry fee is \$225 with a three-game guarantee. The tournament will be pool play with the top four teams advancing. There will also be trophies and awards. For more info, contact Dwayne Jurek at (440) 367-2592.

Wellington Early Bird Baseball Tourney
Running from April 20-22 at Wellington Community Park will be the Wellington Early Bird Tournament. Cost is \$250 per team for the age groups 14U, 12U, and 10U (play date out off at May 1). For more information, call (440) 857-6265.

Softball Tournament
Perfield Park will sponsor an ASA Men's slow pitch softball tournament on April 25-26. The entry fee is \$155 with a fee game minimum. Teams should contact Ed Knepp at (440) 647-3333 before April 24.

Baseball High School Exhibition Series
The Blue Jays Baseball Club is sponsoring an exhibition series for high school varsity and junior varsity squads near Cooperstown, N.Y. Dates are April 25-29 and May 12-13. The club is also sponsoring tournaments during the summer for ages 13U, 14U, 15U, and 16U teams. For more information e-mail Harvey Sanday at Cooperstown14@aol.com or call (613) 559-5759.

Avon Little League Night
Avon Little League will be having a night at Jacobs Field on June 1 for the Indians vs. Tigers game to benefit the league. Tickets are \$20. For tickets or more information, contact Mary or Mike Skolopich at (440) 357-5003.

CORRECTION

In the state wrestling notebook on Sunday, March 4, the last state placer for Huron was incorrectly identified. Jeffery Peterson was the last Huron wrestler to place at the state tournament, taking fourth in 1996.

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